

Game Woes

If sound works fine in Windows, but you get nothing from games, it's quite possible that game has compatibility issues with your sound card, or simply that something's wrong with your DirectX drivers (which you need for playing DirectX-based games). Reinstall the latest version of DirectX and check again. If you still face problems, start the DirectX diagnostic tool by navigating to Start > Run, typing in "dxdiag" and pressing [Enter]. The diagnostic tool will test the sound on your system and will tell you exactly what's wrong.



The DirectX diagnostic tool

4.2 Snap, Crackle, Pop!

All systems go, but sound quality not as you expected? A badly timed click here, a hiss there, some static somewhere, choppy sound—the whole experience just ruined?

Speaker Woes

Check if there are any other electronic devices in the vicinity. Speakers sometimes tend to pick up interference from the surroundings, and having an appliance in the vicinity doesn't help much. Try moving your speakers and wires around and see if it helps. A common culprit is the radio, and should be the first thing to be removed from the immediate surroundings. Your speakers shouldn't be too close to your monitor, either.

Another cause of your problem could be because of how your speakers are placed. Subwoofers are best under your table—for one thing, they sound best from there; secondly, they aren't magnetical-